

How to Play The Word Discovery Challenge

A concise guide to guesses, confidence ratings, clues, timing, and results

Goal Find each hidden five-letter word. You will play one practice word, then 20 scored words.

Time limit You have 100 minutes for the practice word and all 20 scored words together. The timer does not pause between words or when you leave the page.

Step by step

1. **Start with the practice word.** It works like every later word, but it does not count toward your score. The shared timer starts with practice.
2. **Enter a five-letter word.** Type with your keyboard or use the on-screen keys, then select Submit guess. A word that is not in the game dictionary does not use one of your attempts.
3. **Rate your confidence before seeing the clues.** Choose 0 to 10 for the chance that this exact guess is the hidden word. For example, 0 means 0%, 5 means 50%, and 10 means 100%.
4. **Confirm the rating.** Select Confirm confidence and show clues. You cannot enter another guess until you confirm the rating.
5. **Use the color clues.** Compare the letters in your guess with the hidden word, using the key below.

Color	Meaning	What to do
Green	Correct position	Keep the letter in the same position in a later guess.
Yellow	Different position	The letter is in the word; try it in another position.
Gray	Not matched	The letter is not matched in the hidden word for that guess.

Note Each new guess is entered from scratch. Green letters are not automatically copied or locked, so reuse them in their correct positions yourself.

6. **Keep guessing.** Repeat the guess, confidence, and clue steps until you solve the word or use all 10 valid guesses.
7. **Move to the next word.** After a round ends, the answer is shown. Select Next word. After practice, select Finish practice and then Continue to begin the 20 scored words.
8. **Finish and save your results.** After the twentieth word, select See results. Download the JSON or CSV file before selecting Play again, because results are stored only in this browser.

Important rules

- **Ten attempts maximum.** Only valid dictionary words use an attempt.
- **Confidence comes first.** The clues remain hidden until you confirm a confidence rating for the guess.
- **Giving up.** You may select Give up this word when no confidence rating is waiting for confirmation. The round counts as unsuccessful.
- **When time expires.** The game ends automatically. Unconfirmed guesses are not counted, and words you did not reach are recorded separately.
- **Language entry.** Use A-Z in English. In German, enter Ä as AE, Ö as OE, Ü as UE, and ß as SS; the converted word must fill exactly five spaces.

Quick play loop

GUESS → RATE CONFIDENCE → CONFIRM → READ CLUES → REPEAT